Design Research Society
DRS Digital Library

Nordes Conference Series

Aug 6th, 9:00 AM - Aug 8th, 5:00 PM

Affect in more-than-human design practice: An anecdote-based exploration through dialogue

Daphné Hamilton-Jones
Univ. Grenoble Alpes, ENSAG, AAU-CRESSON, France

Anna M. Schröder
Malmö University, School of Arts and Communication, Sweden

Follow this and additional works at: https://dl.designresearchsociety.org/nordes

 Part of the Art and Design Commons

Citation

Hamilton-Jones, D.,and Schröder, A.(2025) Affect in more-than-human design practice: An anecdote-based exploration through dialogue, in Brandt, E., Markussen, T., Berglund, E., Julier, G., Linde, P. (eds.), *Nordes 2025: Relational Design*, 6-8 August, Oslo, Norway. https://doi.org/10.21606/nordes.2025.49

This Research Paper is brought to you for free and open access by DRS Digital Library. It has been accepted for inclusion in Nordes Conference Series by an authorized administrator of DRS Digital Library. For more information, please contact dl@designresearchsociety.org.

AFFECT IN MORE-THAN-HUMAN DESIGN PRACTICE: AN ANECDOTE-BASED EXPLORATION THROUGH DIALOGUE

DAPHNÉ HAMILTON-JONES1
UNIV. GRENOBLE ALPES, ENSAG, AAU-CRESSON
DAPHNE.EM.HAMILTON@GMAIL.COM

ANNA M. SCHRÖDER1
MALMÖ UNIVERSITY
ANNA.SCHRODER@MAU.SE

ABSTRACT

Responding to the contemporary environmental crises, Design strives to continuously define and develop more-than-human design practices. In response, this exploratory piece puts in dialogue two affective anecdotes: we discuss encounters with the ocean and the soil, foregrounding how these experiences have impacted our perspectives on the Design discipline and practice, exploring how, through a reflective dialogue, a relational understanding of these events emerges, while also allowing us to grasp the implicit nature of our more-than-human design practice better. This paper foregrounds the difficulty in expressing affective experiences through words, as well as the value of troubling feelings that emerge when developing an understanding of more-than-human subjectivities while designing.

INTRODUCTION

In response to the contemporary environmental crisis, Design[2] strives to continuously define more-than-human design practice, which considers all humans in constant relation with life and other entities around. We[i] position our argument amid current ecofeminist natureculture movements refusing the harmful objectification of nature (Haraway, 2003; 2016; Savransky, 2021; Stengers, 2018; Stengers et al., 2024; Latour, 2017).

We nurture this discourse with a demonstration of how we relationally make sense of our more-than-human design practices; practices personal to us authors, contextual to our design spaces, and specific to the temporalities and ecologies in which we design. The two meshworks we speak from are context for learning ocean literacy, and soil assemblies in small-scale farming. Both are places that intentionally have more-than-human lifeforms meet each other. On one

[1] Both authors have contributed in equal parts to this paper.

[2] When we write Design as a capitalised word we refer to the discipline, otherwise we refer to the action of doing design, when we write the word in lowercase letters.

This work is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial 4.0 International Licence

https://doi.org/11.21606/nordes.2025.49

hand, we are directing attention to the interwoven-ness of us designers with our more-than-human design contexts, and on the other, to how we are making sense of more-than-human design research together, with this dialogical writing as practised relational research.

After conceptually anchoring our exploration in relationality, more-than-human design, and more-than-human affect, we elaborate on our dialogical writing practice. Along one anecdote from each of our design practice, translating our personal and affective experiences from our design explorations into written language, we bring them into dialogue with each other via responses and reflections. The paper ends with a short concluding discussion of the reflexive dialogue, learning from ocean and soil, and an outlook into learning affectedness in more-than-human design.

RELATIONAL DESIGN PRACTICE

In a relational ontology, thinkers approach complex contexts with their ever-evolving "interactions and interdependencies" (Nielsen & Bjerck, 2022, p.1061), with a focus on the social relations that configure subjects in such systems (Ortega Alvarado, 2024). Allowing relational agency to unfold from being emotionally related to others simultaneously means sidelining discreet individuals in the understanding of reality (Nielsen & Bjerck, 2022)[3].

While relationality is not exclusive to Design, design (research) practices are immensely redirected in the wake of the relational turn in Design (Nielsen & Bjerck, 2022) often associated as a counteraction to the "socially and ecologically harmful modes of designing" (Ortega Alvarado, 2024, p.1). The specialty of relational design commonly lies in sense-making rather than problem-solving (as prominent in traditional design). Relational designers acknowledge the resources and relations of communities, including their own positionality in the context at hand. To design relationally means to sensitively consider one's own role, besides historic perspectives (Nielsen & Bjerck, 2022; Ortega Alvarado, 2024).

A critical partner concept to relational design is more-than-human design, as discussed by Poikolainen Rosén et al. (2024). More-than-human design describes the "broad orientation of designing with the relationships humans have to the rest of the world, including other beings and lively matter and technologies", as they describe (xxii). The authors address the fuzzy definitions of more-than-human design and categorize more-than-human design as a paradigm shift that is applicable to almost any areas that Design can engage with.

AFFECTIVE RELATIONALITY WITH THE (MORE-THAN-HUMAN) WORLD

In this paper, we use the term 'affect' referring to the concept of bodies being moved and affected by each other and feeling(s) as the individual experience of that affectedness. We understand affect as a relational dimension of every situation and event (Massumi, 2015), spanning the collective "flow of resonances" between human and non-human bodies, collective and personal bodies (Ahmed, 2004). While each situation might have a collective mood, or affective atmosphere (Michels, 2015), individual emotional experiences might differ (Åhäll, 2018; Ahmed, 2004; Hemmings, 2012). Design research has engaged with feeling-with the more-than-human world previously, in particular exploring pathways for emotional engagement with the Anthropocene. One example is the project Grief and Hope in Transition (Jönsson & Lindström, 2022; Lindström et al., 2024). Verlie stresses the importance of learning to navigate and work with one's own and others'

[3] This brief overview of relationality mirrors a few of several scholars working in that ontology. For more, see among others Tony Fry, or Arturo Escobar.

affective responses, as a "crucial element of environmental/sustainability/climate change engagement efforts" (Verlie, 2019, p.760). Verlie advises learning to be in touch with one's feelings, being taught and reminded to care for one's own overall well-being, and finding community for this learning process (2019).

LEARNING TO BE AFFECTED THROUGH DIALOGUE

With our exploration, we chime into the call to explicit invisible affective labour within design practice, as Balaam et al. (2019) and Yee et al. (2024) have articulated it. Drawing from several writing practices in the more-than-human research field, Akama and Light (2018) inspire us with their use of auto-ethnographic writing to collectively reflect on the personal histories and experiences embedded in their participatory design (PD) work. This process highlights overlooked aspects of PD while also allowing the authors to shape their practice through co-reflection, as they point out. We also embrace Kofoed and Fritsch's practice of affective event writing, who propose collectively engaging with the "feel-think affectivity" of events (2023, p.228). Åsberg et al. (2020) influence us with their poetic field notes, creating space for situated, practice-based knowledge in academic writing. Finally, Núñez-Pacheco and Poikolainen Rosén (2024) engage with micro-phenomenological interviews, capturing often hard-to-articulate dimensions of research that emerge in more-than-human contexts. In this paper, we put our affective event writings in iterative dialogue through individual writing, aloud reading, responding to each other in speech and text, before editing the writing to gradually reveal the affective layer (figure 1). This presents itself as an exercise in the performance of relational, dialogical sense-making.

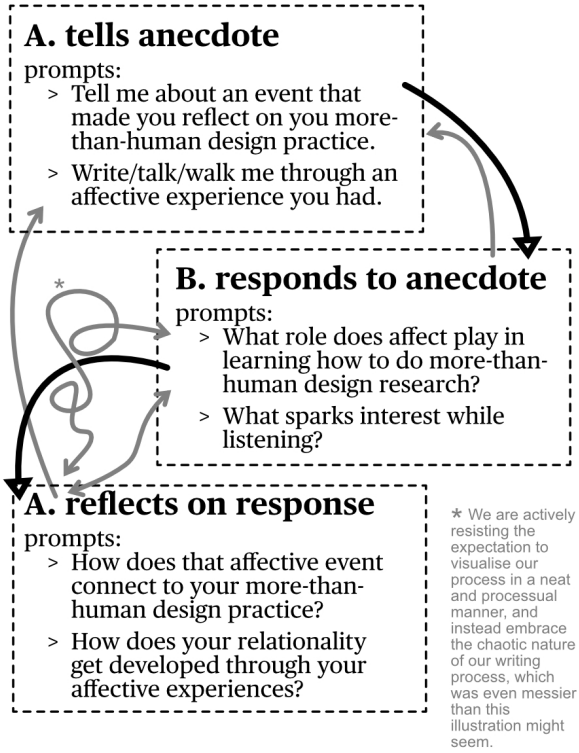


Figure 1: Prompting sequence behind the paper

BEING IN DIALOGUE

ATTUNING TO ARCTIC SOIL: AN ANECDOTE

"In the last couple of years, I, Daphné, spent time WwOOFing[4] in farms, in the hope that I might learn some of these precious agricultural skills that our species is so dependent on.

The first thing that struck me when I arrived in the fjord was the landscape. I knew what was coming, yet that did not keep me from experiencing a deep sense of awe, grabbing me at my core at the sight of the towering mountains that surrounded the ancient body of water near which the farm was built. I had little work to do, and that quickly became an excuse to spend hours gawping at the marvels that surrounded me, losing myself as a patch of weeding came to an end, or as the evening drew in under the eternal arctic sun. In that admiration, constantly outdoors, weeding, painting, reading or sketching, I let my body develop an understanding of the place. I

[4] WwOOF, or Worldwide Opportunities on Organic Farms, is a form of volunteering whereby one can go and support sustainable farming initiatives by providing free labour and being housed and fed by their host.

caught sight of the clouds as they darkened, preparing myself for rain ; I felt how the temperatures dropped and rose with every whim of the sun ; I listened to the cackling of the Icelandic chickens and started to build a sense of what they wanted or avoided."

ALLOWING FEELING-WITH: A RESPONSE

Thank you for taking me with you into this moment of the past. When I, Anna, take in your words, I think to understand the important role of your body feeling itself into a place. What stood out for me is how you held space for serendipitous encounters with surrounding life, though you already had an idea where you would find yourself. It seems like you have actively permitted yourself to be slow, and attentive, to gain an embodied understanding of the work on the farm; I sense a permission to be affected that you gave your self, your body, your body-mind, to embrace particular practices to become capable of being permeated by that knowledge. I am reminded of how Haraway (2016) and Puig de la Bellacasa (2017) speak of response-ability, but also of Rosa's thoughts on bodies as resonant participants in the world (2019). As I hear you, and also have experienced in my field immersions, the bodily knowledge makes particularly much sense within the body it has been collected in. I get curious to understand the chickens and the weather in that place with you, while I understand that words might not be a suitable medium to transfer this kind of knowledge you are describing. It would take my body being in the same place, and even then I would likely encounter other others than you.

EMBODIED LEARNING : A REFLECTION

In a way, your response speaks to how I, Daphné, built embodied knowledge by letting it take a place in my memory. Memories from my previous farm experience in Britain emerged, and the relationships I had built with both meshworks of entangled lives drew together, with the peace each of them afforded to me. I had been looking forward to my time on a farm since then, aware that the hint of boredom that I sometimes felt in that remoteness filled me with a special kind of peace and a capacity to be attentive to the richness of the ecosystem I temporarily became a part of.

This embodied connection with the space was something that inhabited my experience there. As my hands worked the Norwegian soil to extract the weeds that were endangering some crops, they learnt to sense the depth of the roots, their thickness and their hold in the ground, and my thinking became one with my feeling[5], as I cared both for the plants I was pulling out of the soil and the ones whose livelihoods I was protecting.

In line with thinkers such as Fletcher and Tham, with their work on Earth Logic Gardening (2023), these experiences have infused my designerly practices, with the awareness that design can broaden our ability to communicate beyond words. It also feels as though attentiveness to such experiences demands to slow down - something, again, words cannot communicate as well as experiences.

DISSONANT ENCOUNTERS BY THE SHORE: AN ANECDOTE

"As I, Anna, chipped in to help out at the local marine education centre last summer, we usually held a casual conversation on the side of whatever we were doing. One guide mentioned a child who had caught a jellyfish in their hand-held net the week before. Small curious hands had grabbed the animal, trying to grasp its gelatinous texture and - in what must have been overwhelming sensual curiosity - had crushed the jellyfish in their hands. What I was hearing was more than a

[5] I speak of thinking and feeling with words that I borrow from epistemologies of the South, in line with thinkers such as Orlando Fals Borda who theorized the notion of feeling-thinking - sentipensar.

factual report, as I soon noticed myself pulling my shoulders to my ears as I listened, felt my face contorted in a mixture of shock, disgust and pity. During my time there, we talked about the jellyfish's fate a few more times. So too on the day when another particularly delicate fish had ended up in another hand net: a Swedish relative of the seahorse had got its long pipefish snout trapped in one of the tiny holes in the net. An unfortunate turn-out of an otherwise rare and special event. Retelling the moment, the pedagogues' concern came through about the delicate fish being injured while freeing it; and again, I noticed my facial expression rippling, this time emoting my troubled-ness. The broad nosed pipefish seemed alive and well when they released it back into the sea, better off than that one jellyfish. But what did those moments mean for the practice of netting to encounter underwater life, and learning about the sea?"

BROADENING OUR PERCEPTIONS TO MAKE KIN : A RESPONSE

Thank you, Anna, for sharing such an emotionally charged moment. In this anecdote, you exemplify how interactions with non-humans can inhabit our conversations and come to support our collective understanding of their existence, conversations giving way to affect as we let ourselves be touched by the fate of critters around us.

This also foregrounds the value in setting aside time to interact with non-human lifeforms, but also with other members of human society, through such an interaction. People who are different from us, such as children, can offer another perceptual lens through which to view the world, allowing us to enlarge our affective understanding of it. In your anecdote, the child's action seems to bring out empathy for both the jellyfish and the child, in an effort to understand what might have led them to crush the critter.

In line with Haraway, it seems to be that you hereby illustrate what it is to make kin (Haraway, 2016), affectively. As a designer and a design researcher, I have often engaged with others through cold, quantitative methods and forgotten about many lifeforms you talk about here - from children of the human realm to non-human lives that inhabit the world with us. Your experience with them reminds me how we might curate contexts for these interactions to emerge and expand our understanding of that world.

I was also touched by the way you express how you let yourself be troubled without carrying any judgement. You move out of our modernist solutionism (Latour, 2017), ending with a question and no answer.

EMBRACING TROUBLING FEELINGS: A REFLECTION

Just as you frame it, I, Anna, also see these moments as part of a kinning process after witnessing my and others' relation to sea life change towards more caring and gentle encounters. So does language change in the ocean practices I engage with, and over the course of time, people thank the sea life when they are visiting sea creatures' habitats.

I want to attend to the conflicting feelings emerging from relational practices with the wider intention of caring for ocean life and supporting others to develop a caring relationship to marine life, and the momentous struggle to coordinate feelings of guilt or shame from the potential harm of intrusive practices like netting. Dipping into affect scholarship, I have come to refer to such troubling feelings as "affective dissonances", as Hemmings describes them (2012), and as "disorienting dilemmas", to borrow a term from critical thinking theorists (Brookfield, 2012). Those feelings are valuable entry points to critically reflect existing ocean literacy practices, and further on more-than-human design practices. The dissonances in the experiences described in the affective writing above allowed me to grasp what moral questions lie underneath this tension, and what value systems conflict.

Since then, I started to remind myself in more-than-human design processes to attend to troubling feelings around learning with the sea, especially if they appear unexpectedly. These conversations have also led to shared

reflections of the potential of Design to support the transition of practices in systematic value shift (as in towards multispecies philosophies), instead of reinventing tools, or products. Feeling-with the more-than-human got agency to change practices.

CONCLUSION

In this paper, we used affective anecdotes to dialogically explore how encounters with ocean and soil impacted us, and to relationally engage with the impact of such encounters with our perspectives on the Design discipline and more-than-human design practice.

In an almost ritualised back-and-forth, we experienced the translation of affective, situational, and relational knowledge into shared writing as a way to allow ourselves to unpack our affectedness by our design contexts, explicating our more-than-human design practice.

AFFECTIVE ANECDOTAL DIALOGUE TO REFLECT ON MORE-THAN-HUMAN DESIGN PRACTICE

Even though we both initially struggled to write truly affectively, we found that in this dynamic dialogue we were able to bring our subjective field knowledge into an explicit dialogue about our design practice and the role of affect within.

This dialogical sense-making practice, rooted in the aforementioned elaborated methodological blend, had us working with a text-based format to capture and share the affective, contextual, relational experiences which we both collected in the fields of our respective design space. We assume expressing affective experiences depends on personal preferences, and could be explored through e.g., graphic material, embodied performance, or audible content as well as writing. Therefore, we encourage each practitioner to assemble their own dialogue setups. By consciously grounding our design and reflection practice in the personal, the explicit, and the subjective, we are working to brace ourselves to encounter the "conflicting realities, cultural norms and interests" (Akama & Light, 2018) in upcoming design sites.

DISCUSSION

FROM FEELING-WITH THE OCEAN AND THE SOIL

The first anecdote- *attuning to arctic soil* gave us food for thought on allowing serendipitous affection, and letting embodied knowledge fill one's conscience. We saw an important task for (more-than-human) Design in creating conditions that allow such immersion, and letting one get absorbed into curiosity-filled slowness to attune to place. We explored how such experiences shape our learning and design practices, emphasizing that embodied knowledge surpasses traditional verbal communication and expands our ways of knowing and relating to the world, experiencing our entanglements affectively, situationally, and relationally.

Dissonant encounters by the shore foregrounded the troubling feelings sometimes felt when extending our perspectives to other lifeforms, human and non-human. We explored how this can be part of a kinning process, as developing an affective understanding of these other perspectives allows to make kin with them, in line with Haraway (2016). This, in turn, presents itself as a base for critical reflection regarding existing practices, which becomes useful for designers to strengthen their work.

LEARNING AFFECTEDNESS IN MORE-THAN-HUMAN DESIGN

At the end of this exploratory paper, we want to share an outlook into learning feeling-with in more-than-human design. We both entered this research field, with design educations on the fringe of this very field. Within these, neither of us received sufficient room to engage in feeling-with the more-than-human.

The anecdotes we discussed in this paper can be read as part of our affective learning, relationally explored through dialogue. With that in mind, a continuation of this work to lies in the realm of Design education. How can we (re)learn to allow ourselves to be affected by

the more-than-human? How to invite others into feeling-with? How can we invite ourselves to learn affectedness with others?

Ending this exploration, we are glancing at thinkers such as DiSalvo, whose "post-capitalist" Bauhaus pedagogy includes "learning to be affected" alongside a pedagogical proposal for a Bauhaus of the Anthropocene, studying more-than-human relations (2019). Instances like the NORDES summer school 2018 on design and care and 2024 on design after progress point in that direction. We believe further work is necessary to determine what place affective education has in the contemporary Design education landscape, and beyond. Beyond, because, as designers, we understand ourselves as continuous learners, be it concerning our design practice or our work in design education, a thinking in which we invite others into through this paper.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

Together, we want to thank the organisers of the NORDES summer school, which included the people involved in the design research environments 'Design after Progress' and the 'Just Transitions Graduate School'; as well as the careful reading of early drafts by a summer school peer-reviewer, and later by Anna Seravalli, and the constructive feedback from two anonoumous reviewers.

Daphné wants to thank the network of people working in and around urban gardens in Malmö in 2022, Anton who generously opened up his research in 2022, the WwoOF farms that opened their doors to me, and the Tiers-Lieu Paysan de la Martinière that has already generously opened up as my PhD has only just begun; Tom, who gave me generous access to his thesis, Samuel who has been instrumental in bringing me there, Françoise and François who have generously opened doors to me. Anna wants to thank the marine pedagogues and nature guides at the Marine Education Centre in Malmö (Marint Kunskapscenter) for inviting me into their everyday work and challenges.

REFERENCES

Åhäll, L. (2018). Affect as Methodology: Feminism and the Politics of Emotion. *International Political Sociology*, 12(1), pp.36–52. Available from: https://doi.org/10.1093/ips/olx024

Ahmed, S. (2004). Collective Feelings: Or, the Impressions Left by Others. *Theory, Culture & Society*, 21(2), pp.25–42. Available from: https://doi.org/10.1177/0263276404042133

Akama, Y., & Light, A. (2018). Practices of readiness: Punctuation, poise and the contingencies of participatory design. *Proceedings of the 15th Participatory Design Conference: Full Papers*. 1, pp.1-12. Available from: https://doi.org/10.1145/3210586.3210594

Åsberg, C., Holmstedt, J. & Radomska, M. (2020). Methodologies of Kelp: On Feminist Posthumanities, Transversal Knowledge Production and Multispecies Ethics in an Age of Entanglement. In: *The Kelp Congress*. Svolvær, Norway, NNKS Press, pp.11–23. Available from: https://philarchive.org/rec/SBEMOK [Accessed 12 May 2025].

Balaam, M., Comber, R., Clarke, R. E., Windlin, C., Ståhl, A., Höök, K., & Fitzpatrick, G. (2019). Emotion Work in Experience-Centered Design. *Proceedings of the 2019 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*, pp.1–12. Available from: https://doi.org/10.1145/3290605.3300832 [Accessed 12 May 2025].

Brookfield, S. (2012). *Teaching for critical thinking: tools and techniques to help students question their assumptions*. San Francisco: Jossey-Bass.

DiSalvo, C. (2019). Diagrams for Another Bauhaus. In L. Forlano, M. W. Steenson, & M. Ananny. *Bauhaus futures*. Cambridge, Massachusetts: The MIT Press. pp.77–82. Available from: https://doi.org/10.7551/mitpress/12044.003.0011 [Accessed 12 May 2025].

Fletcher, K., & Tham, M. (2023). *Earth Logic Gardening: A practical guide to growing ecological, social, cultural and economic change*. Earth Logic Publishing. Available from: https://earthlogic.info/ [Accessed 12 May 2025].

Haraway, D.J. (2003). *The companion species manifesto: dogs, people, and significant otherness*. Chicago, Prickly Paradigm Press.

Haraway, D.J. (2016). *Staying with the trouble: making kin in the Chthulucene*. Durham London, Duke University Press.

Hemmings, C. (2012). Affective solidarity: Feminist reflexivity and political transformation. *Feminist Theory*, 13(2), pp.147–161. Available from: https://doi.org/10.1177/1464700112442643 [Accessed 12 May 2025].

Jönsson, L., & Lindström, K. (2022). Narrating ecological grief and hope through reproduction and translations. *DRS2022: Bilbao, 25 June - 3 July, Bilbao, Spain.* pp.1-16. Available from: https://doi.org/10.21606/drs.2022.333 [Accessed 12 May 2025].

Kofoed, J. & Fritsch, J. (2023). Affective Event Writing: An Entry Point for Collective Attunement. *Capacious: Journal of Emerging Affect Inquiry*, 3 (1), pp.225–240. Available from: https://doi.org/10.22387/CAP2022.74 [Accessed 12 May 2025].

Latour, B. (2017). *Facing Gaia: eight lectures on the new climatic regime*. Cambridge, UK Medford, MA: Polity.

Lindström, K., Jönsson, L. & Hillgren, P.-A. (2024). Reorientations: Practicing Grief and Hope in Post-Carbon Futures. *PDC '24: Proceedings of the Participatory Design Conference 2024: Full Papers*, 1, pp.187–196. Available from: https://dl.acm.org/doi/10.1145/3666094.3666104 [Accessed 12 May 2025]

Massumi, B. (2015). *The politics of affect*. Cambridge, Polity.

Michels, C. (2015). Researching affective atmospheres. *Geographica Helvetica*, 70(4), pp.255–263. Available from: https://doi.org/10.5194/gh-70-255-2015 [Accessed 12 May 2025].

Nielsen, B. F., & Bjerck, M. (2022). Relational Design. *Proceedings of the Design Society*, *2*, pp.1061–1070. Available from: https://doi.org/10.1017/pds.2022.108 [Accessed 12 May 2025].

Núñez-Pacheco, C. & Poikolainen Rosén, A. (2024). Articulating Felt Senses for More-Than-Human Design: A Viewpoint for Noticing. In: *DIS '24: Proceedings of the 2024 ACM Designing Interactive Systems Conference*. IT University of Copenhagen Denmark, ACM, pp.1029–1043. Available from: https://dl.acm.org/doi/10.1145/3643834.3661554 [Accessed 12 May 2025].

Ortega Alvarado, I.A. (2024). Relationality in design: What can be understood? In: *DRS2024: Boston, 23–28 June, Boston, USA*. pp.1–11. Available from: https://dl.designresearchsociety.org/drs-conference-papers/drs2024/researchpapers/335 [Accessed 12 May 2025].

Rosén, A.P., Salovaara, A., Botero, A. & Juul Søndergaard, M.L. (2024). Introduction. In: *More-Than-Human Design in Practice*. London: Routledge, xix–xxxi. Available from: https://www.taylorfrancis.com/books/9781003467731/chapters/10.4324/9781003467731-1 [Accessed 12 May 2025].

Rosa, H. (2019). *Resonanz: eine Soziologie der Weltbeziehung*. Berlin: Suhrkamp.

Savransky, M. (2021). After progress: Notes for an ecology of perhaps. *Ephemera Journa*l, 21(1), pp.267–281. Available from: https://ephemerajournal.org/contribution/after-progress-notes-ecology-perhaps [Accessed 12 May 2025]

Stengers, I. (2018). *Another science is possible: a manifesto for slow science*. English edition. Cambridge, UK: Polity.

Stengers, I., Higgins, M. & Wallace, M. (2024). In Conversation with Isabelle Stengers: Ontological Politics in Catastrophic Times. In: S. Tolbert, M. F. G. Wallace, M. Higgins, & J. Bazzul eds. *Reimagining Science Education in the Anthropocene.* 2. Cham, Switzerland: Springer Nature Switzerland AG, pp.363–387. Available from: https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-031-35430-4_20 [Accessed 12 May 2025].

Verlie, B. (2019). "Climatic-affective atmospheres": A conceptual tool for affective scholarship in a changing climate. *Emotion, Space and Society*, *33*, pp.1-8. Available from: https://doi.org/10.1016/j.emospa.2019.100623 [Accessed 12 May 2025].

Yee, J., Akama, Y., Avendano Franco, A., Chen, K.-L., Imanishi, H., Kikuchi, Y., Kushinsky, S., Ralston, N., Teasley, S., & Teerapong, K. (2024). Invisible Designing: Emotional and Affective Labour in Relational Participatory Practices. *Participatory Design Conference 2024*, pp.67–72. Available from: https://doi.org/10.1145/3661455.366987 [Accessed 12 May 2025].

[i] We, authors of this paper, should like to acknowledge some elements regarding the position from where we speak, colouring our epistemology, and reflexivity in this paper. We are both white, cisgender, queer, able-bodied women, with an international background. Anna is German, and lives in Sweden, Daphné is binational French and British, and recently moved back to France. We know each other through the Swedish design academic world, and this is the first time we write together and articulate a positionality statement. We wrote this article through computer screens, separated by over a thousand kilometres of land and sea, following the 2025 edition of the NORDES summer school where we found that we shared similar interests regarding the topics that are hereby explored. We acknowledge our privileged positions to be employed at institutions which embrace research practices as ours. In terms of our ecological positionalities, Daphné grew up in a low-density suburban environment on the fringes of a large European metropolis, surrounded by the song of birds and rich flora - she is currently rooting herself in the ecology of farmed soil in the Auvergne-Rhône-Alpes region. Anna grew up in an intensely urban ecosystem, where foxes were the largest mammals to rarely meet, and is recently dip diving into marine life around the Öresund sound, and its coastal ecology.